

Mechanisms in Motion

Day 1 Energy for Every Stage of Growth

We can launch a professional remote video podcast on four software subscriptions (all four run in your web browser, nothing to install) plus one matched hardware kit each, edited in Descript on a workflow you learn in a week. The job between now and late August is to buy two kits, learn Descript on scrap footage, run one full test with a stand-in, then record eight episodes in a four-week sprint and publish weekly.

New to this? Every step links to a plain-language how-to guide (jargon decoded, with a prompt for Claude/ChatGPT). Start by downloading the calendar that runs the project: [download the .ics](#), then [how to import it](#).

THE STACK AT A GLANCE › ALL HOW-TO GUIDES

LAYER	WHAT WE USE	COST	WHY
Record	Riverside.fm Pro	\$24/mo	Everyone records locally in their browser; a dropped connection never loses the take. Guests join with one link, no install.
Edit	Descript Creator	\$24/mo	Edit video by editing text. Auto-cleans audio, removes "ums," switches cameras, cuts social clips.
Host & publish	Transistor.fm Pro	\$49/mo	One upload feeds Apple + Spotify (audio) and auto-posts the video to YouTube.
Schedule	Calendly Standard	\$15/mo	Guests self-book; auto-handles their timezone and sends them the link and prep doc.
Gear (each)	Matched host kit	~\$850	Studio mic, 4K webcam, key light, headphones, boom arm. Two identical kits.
Run-rate	4 subscriptions	~\$112/mo	Plus ~\$1,700 one-time for both kits. Riverside can pause after the sprint.

THE PATH, IN FIVE MOVES

JUN–JUL	EARLY AUG	AUG 25 – SEP 17	SEP 17–21	SEP 22 →
Order 2 kits. Set up the 4 accounts. Learn Descript on scrap footage.	Day-1 setup + a full test run with a stand-in guest.	Record 8 episodes, Tue/Thu mornings, two per week.	Final edits; build a 1–2 episode buffer; queue the season.	Launch. Publish every Tuesday from the recorded backlog.

RICH OWNS LOGISTICS

- The four accounts, billing, and channel setup
- Both hardware kits and the test run
- The Descript edit and weekly publishing
- The Calendly booking calendar and prep one-pager

CARLA OWNS THE GUEST SLATE

- The 6–8 guests for the launch block and their order
- Warm outreach and the invite
- The question arc per guest (with Rich)
- Co-host on every recording

Four subscriptions, one job each

Each tool does exactly one thing and hands cleanly to the next: Riverside records, Descript edits, Transistor publishes, Calendly schedules. Buy each on annual billing and run them on one shared account so there is a single login per layer.

Riverside.fm

\$24/mo

PRO PLAN · RECORDING STUDIO

Records every person's camera and mic locally (to their own computer, not just over the internet), so a guest's bad wifi can't ruin the take. Guests click one link in Chrome, no account, no download. One-click export hands each person to Descript as a separate track (each voice as its own file). **Record at 1080p**, the standard HD; 4K just makes files four times bigger for no visible gain.

Descript

\$24/mo

CREATOR PLAN · EDITING

You edit the video by editing the transcript. One click cleans the audio (Studio Sound), removes filler words (the "ums"), and switches between cameras automatically (Automatic Multicam). It also generates the vertical clips for social. Annual billing is \$24/mo; month-to-month is \$35.

Transistor.fm

\$49/mo

PROFESSIONAL · HOSTING

Your one upload puts the show in every podcast app and auto-posts the full video to your YouTube channel. Unlimited shows on one bill, so a second AES show later costs nothing extra.

Calendly

\$15/mo

STANDARD · BOOKING

Guests self-book a recording slot; it detects their timezone and emails them the Riverside link, the prep one-pager, and reminders automatically. One shared booking calendar avoids double-booking.

HOW AN EPISODE REACHES THE WORLD

GUARANTEED PATH (SET UP ONCE, RUNS ITSELF)

Audio: Transistor → one RSS feed → Apple Podcasts + Spotify + every podcast app, automatically on each publish. (An RSS feed is the standard format podcast apps watch for new episodes; Transistor manages it, which is why one upload reaches every app.) **Video:** Transistor auto-posts the full episode to **YouTube**, the primary home for video discovery (about a third of US podcast viewing).

BONUS PATH (ONLY IF IT'S LIVE ON THE ACCOUNT)

Native **video** on Apple Podcasts and Spotify ships through Transistor's HLS distribution (a format that plays video inside those apps, not just audio), still rolling out in 2026. Treat it as a bonus we switch on if available, never something the launch depends on. YouTube is the guaranteed video home.

"RECORD ONCE, CLIP MANY"

The full edited episode is the master. From it: the audio goes to every podcast app automatically, the full video lands on YouTube, and Descript finds the best moments and generates 2–4 short vertical clips (phone-screen format) for YouTube Shorts, LinkedIn, and Instagram, from which you keep the best. Audio still reaches roughly twice the weekly US audience of video, so the show never waits on video to ship.

Two identical kits, weighted toward the mic [› how to set up your kit](#)

Buy two matching ~\$850 kits, one for Rich in San Diego and one for Carla near Seattle, built around a plug-and-play USB mic (it plugs straight into your laptop, no extra hardware box) and a webcam that needs no capture card. The mic takes \$279 of the \$850 because a guest will forgive your camera before they forgive your audio.

ITEM	BUY THIS	PRICE	WHY THIS ONE
Microphone	Shure MV7+ (black)	\$279	Plugs into your laptop with one cable. Auto-levels your voice, so you never adjust anything while talking.
Webcam	Logitech MX Brio 4K	\$199	One USB-C cable, sharp in low light. No dummy battery, no overheating, no capture card.
Key light	Elgato Key Light Neo	\$99	USB-powered, no Wi-Fi or app to fail on record day. Place 45° off to one side.
Headphones	Sony MDR-7506	\$100	Fully enclosed cups, so the mic doesn't pick up what you're hearing (no echo). Plug straight into the mic.
Boom arm	RODE PSA1+	\$126	Silent springs, rated to hold the heavy MV7+ without drooping mid-record.
Room treatment	Reflection filter / foam	~\$50	Sits behind the mic to kill echo. A rug, curtains, and a bookshelf do the rest free.
Per kit	6 items	~\$850	Two kits ~\$1,700. Inside budget with headroom for cables.

THE ONE DOLLAR THAT MATTERS MOST

The microphone. If anything has to flex, keep the MV7+ and trade down elsewhere. We run it in "Auto Level" mode with light denoise and **reverb off** (reverb is an artificial-echo effect; keep it off). A pro-mixer upgrade path exists later but is not needed now.

GUEST UPLIFT KIT (OPTIONAL, FOR MARQUEE GUESTS ONLY)

Guests are the weakest link in remote audio and video; a senior operator on a bad laptop webcam will be the most-watched face in the episode. For high-value guests, offer to ship a tiny uplift kit ahead of the record: a clip-on light and a USB mic or clip-on lavalier mic (about \$25–60 total). Everyone else uses what they have; the platform protects the audio.

BUY FROM

Shure MV7+: [shure.com](https://www.shure.com) or B&H · Logitech MX Brio: [logitech.com](https://www.logitech.com) · Elgato Key Light Neo: [elgato.com](https://www.elgato.com) · Sony MDR-7506: [B&H](https://www.bhphotovideo.com) or Sweetwater · RODE PSA1+: [rode.com](https://www.rodeteam.com) · reflection filter: Amazon (TONOR / TroyStudio). Order both kits in one pass so they arrive together and stay identical. Full setup walkthrough: [hardware-setup guide](#).

Record clean, edit by text, ship to spec

Quality is decided at record time, not in the edit. Get separate local tracks and matched settings on the way in, then Descript does the heavy lifting on the way out. Two rules prevent almost every disaster: confirm the real mic is selected, and never close the tab until uploads finish.

SESSION-DAY CHECKLIST › RECORDING HOW-TO

- ☐ Both hosts join 10 min early in Chrome
- ☐ In Riverside, select the MV7+ as the mic (not the laptop default)
- ☐ Confirm "separate tracks / local recording" is **ON** (each voice saved as its own file)
- ☐ Headphones on for everyone (kills echo)
- ☐ Both hosts run a QuickTime audio backup (free local safety copy)
- ☐ Hit Record, say the slate ("Episode N, take 1"), pause 3 seconds silent (gives the editor a point to line up tracks)
- ☐ Record the conversation
- ☐ **At the end, STAY on the page until every track shows 100% uploaded**

IF A GUEST'S AUDIO IS ROUGH

Ask them, live: move closer to the screen, turn off fans/AC, put on headphones. Do it in the warm-up minutes, not in the edit.

THE DESCRIPT EDIT (4–6 HRS EARLY, 2–3 LATER) › EDIT HOW-TO

- 1 Import the multitrack (the recording with each person on their own track)
- 2 Apply **Studio Sound** (one-click noise cleanup) per track at **60–80%** (not 100%, it gets robotic)
- 3 Edit by deleting text; then Remove Filler Words, keeping a few natural ones
- 4 Run **Automatic Multicam** (auto camera-switching), then fix the obvious miscuts
- 5 Add captions (auto-synced from the transcript)
- 6 Generate 2–4 vertical clips; keep the best; hook in first 2 seconds
- 7 Export video for YouTube and audio for Transistor

EXPORT TO SPEC: THE SAME NUMBERS EVERY TIME › WHAT THESE MEAN, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

In plain English: make every episode the same loudness as other professional shows, sharp HD video, and identical audio in the YouTube and podcast versions. Descript's export presets do almost all of this for you; the numbers below are just the targets. [Every term decoded here.](#)

–14 LUFS (how loud; matches Spotify/YouTube)

–1.0 dBTP (a safety ceiling so audio never distorts)

1080p, 30fps, H.264 MP4 (HD video) → YouTube

stereo MP3/AAC, 48kHz (podcast audio) → Transistor

30fps for everyone (keeps lips in sync)

in the video and the podcast file

Pre-publish QA gate (a 30-second check before each episode goes out): (1) confirm the export reads –14 LUFS / –1.0 dBTP (Descript shows it); (2) play the video at the start, middle, and last minute and check the mouths match the words; (3) confirm captions still match at the end. [Publish + QA how-to.](#)

Guests self-book; the system preps them

One Calendly event and one prep doc run the entire guest journey. Carla sources and invites the guest; the guest books their own slot; Calendly handles timezones and sends everything they need. The tech check happens in the first five minutes of the recording.

THE ONE CALENDLY EVENT › HOW TO BUILD IT

- **Name:** "Mechanisms in Motion: Recording"
- **Length:** 75 min (60 of conversation + warm-up + slack)
- **Buffers:** 15 min before and after (so you're never rushed or double-booked)
- **Location:** the Riverside studio link (Riverside's one permanent room link); paste it once and every booking carries it
- **Availability:** a dedicated block, Tue/Thu mornings Pacific, capped at 1–2 recordings/day; no Saturdays
- **Intake questions:** headline/title, LinkedIn or bio link, one Amazon-mechanism story they want to tell
- **Owner:** one shared booking calendar; the co-host is a guest on the invite

THE PREP ONE-PAGER (ONE DOC, REUSED)

- The show premise and the "Day 1 Energy" tagline
- The 5–6 question arc for their episode
- Format: conversational, ~60 min, video on
- The 4-line tech checklist: **laptop + Chrome, headphones on, wired internet (an Ethernet cable to the router) or sit near the router, close Slack/email/notifications**
- "We record locally, so a dropped connection won't ruin the audio. If you glitch, keep talking."
- What to bring: one or two stories, a metric or two

THE GUEST JOURNEY, END TO END

CARLA INVITES

Warm outreach; sends the Calendly link.

GUEST BOOKS

Picks a slot; Calendly sends link + prep doc + reminders.

RECORD DAY

5-min device check, then record. Hosts run the session checklist.

AFTER

Edit, publish on its scheduled Tuesday, send the guest their clips.

RELEASE CADENCE

Record the 8 plus one hosts-only evergreen (a no-guest episode held in reserve), then publish **weekly on a fixed day** ("new episodes every Tuesday"). **Launch gate: do not launch until 4 episodes are fully edited and QA-passed**; editing, not recording, is the real constraint. **Never publish below a one-episode buffer**; if it hits zero, pause the streak on purpose rather than ship unedited. Use Transistor's scheduled-publish (queue episodes to go live on future dates automatically) to load the season, and start booking Season 2 in mid-October so the show never runs out of episodes. [Publish + QA how-to](#).

From late-August recording, back to this week

Back-solving from a late-August record start, the long-lead items are buying gear and learning Descript, both of which must finish before the early-August test run. Everything else is a one-time account setup we do once and never touch again.

BY WHEN	MILESTONE	WHAT "DONE" LOOKS LIKE
This week (Jun 3)	Lock the plan + dates with Carla	Stack approved; Aug/Sept recording dates on both calendars (this ICS).
Mid-June	Carla starts the guest slate	First guests identified and invited. Gate: 3+ guests booked by late July before the gear spend.
By Jul 1	Order both hardware kits	Two identical kits ordered early to absorb back-order risk; assembled by late July.
Late July	Learn Descript on scrap footage	Rich runs one mock edit end to end: Studio Sound, multicam, clip, export.
Early Aug	Day-1 software setup (see below)	All four accounts live; feeds submitted; YouTube connected.
Thu Aug 13	Full test run	Stand-in record; uploads complete; separate-track export; lips match the words to the END. Rehearse a disconnect and a degraded guest.
Aug 25 – Sep 17	Record 8 episodes	Two per week, Tue/Thu mornings. Each one edited within a few days.
Tue Sep 22	Launch	First episode publishes; weekly Tuesdays thereafter from the backlog.

DAY-1 SOFTWARE SETUP CHECKLIST (ONE TIME, EARLY AUGUST) › [SETUP HOW-TO](#)

- ☐ Create all four accounts on annual billing (Riverside, Descript, Transistor, Calendly)
- ☐ In Riverside, enable "Export to Descript" (email support now if the button is missing)
- ☐ Connect the YouTube channel inside Transistor so video auto-posts
- ☐ Publish a trailer now and submit the feed (register the show with Apple + Spotify) early; review takes days
- ☐ Build the Calendly "Recording" event (Riverside link, buffers, intake questions)
- ☐ Write the guest prep one-pager (Google Doc, view-only)
- ☐ Decide who edits: Rich drafts, Carla reviews via shared Descript link

YOUR CALENDAR IS THE SPINE · EVERYTHING YOU NEED IS LINKED HERE

Every calendar event carries **what to do**, **what "right" looks like**, and a **prompt** you can copy into Claude or ChatGPT for step-by-step help. The links below open plain reading pages (no coding, just click and read):

1. Start here (5-minute setup): [CARLA-START-HERE](#) · **2. The calendar** (download + import): [download the .ics file](#)

3. The how-to guides (every step, jargon decoded): [all guides](#) · **4. The full project**: github.com/rwsmith96/mechanisms-in-motion